

CHALLENGES IN TRANSLATING RUSSIAN TECHNICAL & MILITARY TERMINOLOGY INTO ENGLISH: STRATEGIES FOR EQUIVALENCE SELECTION AND CONCEPTUAL TRANSFER

چالشهای ترجمه اصطلاحات فنی و نظامی از زبان روسی به فارسی؛ بررسی راهبردهای معادل‌یابی و انتقال مفهومی

Ali Zomorodi

Independent Researcher

Corresponding author: Misaghzomorod2200@gmail.com

ORCID: 0009-0005-1827-7731

Abstract

Translating technical and military terminology from Russian into English is a challenging area of specialized translation because the two languages organize terminology through different lexical, syntactic, and conceptual patterns, while many terms are strongly dependent on their specialized context. In such texts, a word-for-word equivalent does not necessarily provide an accurate representation of the intended concept. The translator must therefore consider not only the linguistic form of a term but also its position within the conceptual system of the relevant field.

This study examines major challenges in selecting English equivalents for Russian technical and military terms and analyzes strategies for transferring their specialized meanings into English. The study follows a descriptive-analytical approach and draws on selected terminology from technical, military, and particularly aerospace domains. The analysis focuses on polysemy, differences in semantic range, multiword terminology, contextual dependence, differences between conceptual systems, and the role of subject-matter knowledge.

The findings indicate that successful equivalence selection often requires moving beyond literal translation toward conceptual transfer. The simultaneous use of specialized dictionaries, textual sources, contextual comparison, and subject-matter knowledge can improve translation accuracy. On this basis, a six-stage model is proposed for Russian-English terminology work: term identification, domain identification, contextual analysis, concept identification, comparison of equivalents, and final evaluation and consolidation.

Keywords: Technical terminology; military terminology; Russian-English translation; equivalence selection; conceptual transfer; terminology

1. Introduction

Specialized translation differs from general translation in the extent to which meaning depends on the conceptual system of a particular field. In a general text, a translator may sometimes rely on the common meaning of a word and on the immediate context of a sentence to arrive at an acceptable equivalent. In a technical or military text, however, the same lexical item may form part of a terminological network, and its meaning may become clear only through its relationship with other terms. If a term denotes a component of a system, for example, its English equivalent should be compatible with the names of the other components of that system. Consequently, examining a term at the sentence and text levels, in addition to consulting lexical resources, is essential for reducing ambiguity. This also means that translation quality cannot be evaluated solely by formal similarity between two words; the relevant question is whether a specialist reader in the target language receives the same concept and the same technical relationship.

Technical translation is therefore not limited to recognizing vocabulary in the source and target languages. A specialized translator must identify concepts within the source-domain system and represent them by acceptable resources in the target language. This issue becomes particularly important in technical and military texts because their terms commonly refer to specific objects, processes, systems, capabilities, properties, or relationships within a professional domain.

Russian has an extensive body of specialized terminology in scientific, industrial, technical, military, and aerospace fields. Many Russian terms are formed as multiword combinations, noun compounds, adjective-noun combinations, or other nominal structures. English may represent the same concepts through different syntactic patterns or through established terms whose internal structure does not correspond to that of the Russian expression. Thus, apparent similarity between the components of a Russian term and English words does not necessarily indicate that a direct and usable equivalent exists.

For example, the Russian word “управление” may correspond to English control, management, administration, or guidance depending on the field and the terminological combination in which it occurs. Choosing one equivalent without considering the domain and the larger expression can alter the meaning of the text. Similar problems arise with broad Russian words such as “установка”, “система”, and “обеспечение”, whose meanings and functions vary considerably across general and specialized contexts.

The problem is especially significant in military texts. A term may refer to a system, an operational capability, a technical characteristic, or a defined process and an inappropriate equivalent may change the perceived relationship between the components or functions of a system. In addition, military terminology frequently distinguishes between equipment, capability, function, and operational role. The translator therefore needs to identify what kind of concept is being named before selecting an English expression.

For these reasons, the translation of technical and military terminology should not be treated simply as the replacement of Russian words with English words. The central task is the transfer of a specialized concept within the conceptual and terminological system of the target language.

2. Problem Statement and Research Objectives

One of the fundamental problems in Russian-English translation of technical and military terminology is the absence of one-to-one correspondence between the terminological systems of the two languages. A Russian term may have several possible English equivalents, while a single English term may correspond to different Russian expressions in different contexts. This situation becomes more complicated when the term occurs in a multiword combination. Translating every component independently and then assembling the results may produce an expression that is grammatically possible but technically inaccurate. For example, in the Russian combination “система управления полётом”, independent translation of the components may lead to flight management system. In an aerospace context, however, the intended concept may be flight control system. The difference is not merely stylistic: control and management represent different conceptual relationships. The example demonstrates why the unit of translation in specialized terminology is often not an isolated word but the complete terminological combination and the concept it denotes. The main objective of this study is to examine the factors that affect the selection of English equivalents for Russian technical and military terminology. The specific objectives are to identify major equivalence problems, examine the role of specialized context in resolving polysemy, compare literal translation with conceptual transfer, consider the role of subject-matter knowledge, and propose a practical procedure for selecting and evaluating Russian-English equivalents.

3. Research Questions

The study addresses the following questions:

1. What factors create the main difficulties in translating Russian technical and military terminology into English?
2. What role does specialized context play in selecting English equivalents for polysemous Russian terms?
3. Under what conditions does literal translation fail to convey the intended Russian technical concept accurately?
4. How does subject-matter knowledge affect the quality of terminological equivalence?
5. What procedure can be used to select and evaluate Russian-English technical and military equivalents?

4. Review of Previous Research

Research on specialized terminology and technical translation has repeatedly emphasized the relationship between a term in the source language and the concept it represents in a particular field. Studies of scientific and technical translation commonly identify terminological density, conceptual precision, the structure of multiword terms, and contextual dependence as important factors in translation quality. These observations are particularly relevant when a source-language term has a broad lexical meaning but a narrow specialized meaning in a given text.

Research concerning Russian scientific and technical vocabulary has also examined the structural characteristics of specialized terminology and the difficulties involved in translating it. Russian technical terminology makes extensive use of word formation and multiword combinations, which can create challenges when the target language organizes the same conceptual relations differently. Military and technical terminology likewise contains combinations whose meaning cannot always be inferred by translating each component separately.

Research in the Russian-Persian direction, reflected in studies of military terminology dictionaries and technical or aviation terminology, also demonstrates the importance of considering terminological structure, field-specific meaning, and differences between lexical systems. Bilingual dictionaries are particularly useful because they provide a set of possible equivalents; nevertheless, the final choice remains dependent on the translator and the context.

Much of the existing work focuses on describing terminology, identifying translation difficulties, or presenting equivalents. The present study concentrates more specifically on the process of conceptual transfer and equivalence selection in context. Its purpose is not to claim that one translation strategy is universally applicable, but to show how different strategies can be selected according to the relationship between term, concept, domain, and target-language usage.

5. Research Methodology

The study is applied in purpose and descriptive-analytical in method. The data consist of selected Russian terms from technical, military, and aerospace domains. The examples were selected according to three criteria: specialized usage; the possibility of polysemy or variation in English equivalents; and the possibility of comparing literal translation with conceptual transfer.

First, the meaning of the Russian term is identified in its specialized context. Second, the internal structure of the term and the semantic relations among its components are examined. Third, possible English equivalents are identified and evaluated according to conceptual accuracy, compatibility with English technical terminology, contextual appropriateness, and consistency with the terminology used elsewhere in the text. Thus, an appropriate equivalent is not necessarily the closest word-for-word rendering; it is the expression that conveys the intended specialized concept with the least ambiguity in the target language.

The evaluation also takes into account the fact that a target-language expression can sound natural to a general reader while still being inappropriate in a specialist domain. Terminological naturalness must therefore be understood as domain-specific acceptability. This principle is important when selecting between competing English expressions that are all grammatically possible but differ in technical usage.

6. Theoretical Framework

6.1. Equivalence Selection in Specialized Translation

Equivalence selection is a central stage of specialized translation. In general translation, a translator may sometimes transfer part of a word's meaning by choosing a semantically close target-language item. In specialized translation, however, the relation between a term and a specialized concept is more important. A technical term normally forms part of a conceptual system, so its translation should also be compatible with neighboring terms and with the established terminology of the field.

Equivalence selection can therefore be viewed as a multi-criteria decision. The translator first identifies possible candidates and then evaluates them according to their relation to the source concept, their use in authentic target-language texts, their compatibility with the domain, and their consistency with the terminology of the document. This approach prevents a dictionary entry from being treated automatically as the final translation.

6.2. Literal Translation and Conceptual Transfer

Two broad approaches can be distinguished in terminology work: literal transfer and conceptual transfer. In literal transfer, the translator attempts to preserve the components and structure of the source term as far as possible. This can be effective when the semantic range and terminological conventions of the two languages correspond closely.

Conceptual transfer begins with identification of the specialized concept and then selects a target-language expression that represents that concept, even when its lexical or syntactic structure differs from the source term. The distinction is important because different languages may encode the same technical relationship in different ways. Conceptual transfer does not mean abandoning literal translation; rather, it provides a criterion for deciding when literal translation is sufficient and when it must be modified.

7. Characteristics of Russian Technical and Military Terminology

Russian technical and military terminology is structurally diverse. Some terms are single nouns, while others are multiword combinations. In aerospace texts, for example, terms such as “фюзеляж”, “лонжерон”, “шпангоут”, and “обшивка” refer to specific structural elements. Their English equivalents may be relatively stable in an established aerospace context: fuselage, spar or main spar, frame or fuselage frame, and skin, respectively.

The relative stability of such terms contrasts with broader items such as “управление”, “установка”, and “система”. These words have wider semantic ranges and cannot be assigned a single English equivalent without reference to context. The translator must therefore distinguish between terminology with a relatively stable domain-specific equivalent and terminology whose meaning is activated by its combination and context.

Another characteristic is the importance of terminological networks. When several terms occur in the same technical description, their mutual relations can help identify the intended meaning. Knowledge of one component of an aircraft structure, for example, can help interpret neighboring terms. Consequently, terminological analysis should not isolate every word from the system in which it functions.

8. First Challenge: Absence of One-to-One Equivalence

One of the most significant difficulties in technical and military translation is the lack of one-to-one correspondence between Russian and English terms. The Russian word “установка” may refer, depending on context, to an installation, unit, apparatus, system, facility, or equipment associated with a particular technical function. In some combinations, the appropriate English expression may not preserve the Russian noun as an independent lexical item at all.

The military combination “пусковая установка” illustrates the problem. It denotes equipment designed to launch missiles or other munitions, and its English rendering depends on the type of system being described. Translating “установка” independently as installation or facility would therefore be misleading. The complete combination must be analyzed first, and the functional role of the equipment must be identified before an English equivalent is chosen.

This example demonstrates that the terminological unit should often be analyzed at the level of the full combination. Component-by-component translation is not necessarily wrong in principle, but it becomes unreliable when the components have different semantic values inside a specialized combination.

9. Second Challenge: Polysemy and Context Dependence

Many Russian lexical items used in technical texts are polysemous. “Управление” is a particularly useful example. Depending on context, it can be associated with control, management, administration, or guidance. In “система управления полётом”, the relevant concept is flight control; in an administrative context, the same lexical item may refer to management or administration.

This means that the translator should not assign a fixed English equivalent to every occurrence of a polysemous Russian term. Context is not merely an additional source of information after dictionary consultation; it is one of the principal mechanisms through which the intended specialized sense is determined. The translator should examine the surrounding sentence, the larger document, the domain, and the function of the term within the system being described.

Contextual analysis is also important when a Russian term has a broader semantic range than its English technical counterpart. A general dictionary may list several meanings, but only one may correspond to the concept activated in a particular technical combination. The translator therefore moves from lexical possibility to terminological selection.

10. Third Challenge: Multiword Terminological Combinations

Russian technical and military terminology frequently occurs in multiword combinations. These combinations may be translated into English with a different word order or with an established expression whose internal structure is not transparent from the Russian form. The translator must therefore identify the semantic head and determine which components specify function, object, domain, or operational role.

The combination “система управления полётом” provides a clear example. A literal rendering such as flight management system is lexically plausible, but in an aerospace context the intended concept may be flight control system. The appropriate English expression is determined by the conceptual relation between flight and control, not simply by the dictionary meanings of the individual Russian words.

Analysis of multiword terminology should therefore proceed from the whole to the parts. The translator first asks what entity or function the complete combination denotes, and then examines how the components contribute to that meaning. This procedure reduces the risk of creating English combinations that are grammatically correct but unfamiliar or conceptually inaccurate to specialists.

11. Fourth Challenge: Aerospace Terminology and the Role of Subject-Matter Knowledge

Aerospace terminology clearly illustrates the relationship between translation and subject-matter knowledge. A translator with general linguistic competence may find the common meaning of a Russian word, but recognizing its exact aerospace concept requires knowledge of the field. The Russian word “планер”, for

instance, may denote different concepts depending on the type of technical text, and its equivalent should be selected only after the relevant domain and context have been established.

The same applies to terms for aircraft structures, such as “лонжерон”, “шпангоут”, and “обшивка”. These terms belong to a coherent technical system. Without knowledge of aircraft structure, a translator may choose English expressions that are understandable in ordinary language but are not the conventional or sufficiently precise terms used in aerospace documentation.

Subject-matter knowledge is therefore not an optional supplement to linguistic competence. It contributes directly to concept identification. When several technical terms occur together, knowledge of the system can reveal whether a candidate equivalent describes a structural component, a control function, an installation, or an operational capability. In this sense, specialized translation requires coordination among language knowledge, terminology knowledge, and domain knowledge.

12. Fifth Challenge: Military Terminology and Differences between Conceptual Systems

In military terminology, equivalence selection is not limited to names of equipment. Military texts contain terms for capabilities, operations, systems, functions, performance characteristics, and operational roles. The translator must distinguish between the object itself and what that object is designed or authorized to do.

For example, “боевая нагрузка” may correspond to combat payload in a context where the term denotes the payload carried for combat purposes. “Боевой радиус” corresponds to combat radius as an established military concept. Likewise, “система управления огнём” corresponds to fire-control system. These examples show that military terminology often has conventional English equivalents that cannot be derived reliably through literal translation alone.

The issue is particularly important because military terminology may differentiate closely related concepts. The name of a system, its function, and its operational capability may require separate English terms. A translator who ignores these distinctions can produce a linguistically smooth text while weakening the conceptual precision of the original. Terminological accuracy therefore depends on understanding the military system in which the term functions.

13. Strategies for Equivalence Selection

The analysis suggests several principal strategies for selecting English equivalents for Russian technical and military terminology.

13.1. Use of an Established Technical Equivalent

If a term has an established equivalent in English technical literature, that equivalent should normally be preferred to a newly constructed translation. Established terminology improves consistency, facilitates recognition by specialists, and connects the translated text with the wider professional literature.

13.2. Conceptual Transfer

When no direct equivalent is available, the translator should identify the specialized concept and select the English expression that represents the same concept. This may require a substantial change in lexical or syntactic structure.

13.3. Conceptual Description

Where no concise and established equivalent exists, a descriptive expression can communicate the function or nature of the source concept. Although less compact, such a solution may be preferable to an opaque literal translation, especially at the first occurrence of an unfamiliar term.

13.4. Borrowing

In some technical fields, particularly where international terminology is widespread, borrowing may be appropriate. The decision should nevertheless be compatible with English usage and with the genre of the target document. Borrowing should not be used simply because a literal equivalent is difficult to construct.

13.5. Combining Strategies

In some cases, the first occurrence can include an explanatory English equivalent together with the Russian or international form. Once the concept has been established, the shorter English term can be used consistently. This strategy can reduce ambiguity without overloading every subsequent occurrence with explanation.

14. Comparison of Literal Translation and Conceptual Transfer

Literal translation is effective when the structure and semantic range of a Russian term correspond sufficiently to established English usage. However, when the two terminological systems divide or organize a conceptual field differently, conceptual transfer becomes necessary.

For “система управления полётом”, a literal translation such as flight management system may be understandable, but analysis of the aerospace concept indicates that “управление” refers to control of flight rather than management in the organizational sense. Flight control system therefore represents the intended concept more accurately in the selected context.

The difference between literal translation and conceptual transfer should not be reduced to a simple opposition between “correct” and “incorrect.” A literal expression may be grammatically valid and semantically

understandable while still being less appropriate terminologically. The relevant criterion is the degree to which the target expression matches the specialized concept and the conventions of the target field.

This distinction also explains why translators should not reject a literal solution automatically. If an established English term closely mirrors the Russian structure, preserving the structure may improve clarity and consistency. Conceptual transfer becomes necessary when formal similarity interferes with conceptual accuracy or produces an expression that specialists would not normally use.

15. The Role of Specialized Dictionaries and Textual Sources

Bilingual and multilingual specialized dictionaries are essential resources for terminology work, but dictionary consultation alone is not always sufficient. A dictionary may list several English equivalents for a Russian word, while the final choice depends on the field, the combination, and the genre of the source text.

Authentic target-language texts are especially valuable because they demonstrate how specialists actually use a candidate term. Comparing several occurrences in manuals, technical documents, academic publications, standards, or other relevant sources can reveal which equivalent is conventional and what conceptual distinctions it carries. Textual evidence can therefore confirm or challenge a dictionary-based hypothesis.

A practical sequence is:

Russian term or combination → domain identification → contextual analysis → concept identification → consultation of specialized sources → comparison of candidate equivalents → final selection. This sequence reduces the probability of choosing an equivalent merely because it appears first in a general dictionary.

The use of several independent sources is also useful when terminology is unstable or varies between subfields. In such cases, the translator should identify whether the variation reflects genuine conceptual differences, differences between institutions or genres, or simple inconsistency. The final choice should then be documented and used consistently throughout the translated text.

16. Proposed Model for Equivalence Selection

Based on the analysis, the process of translating Russian technical and military terminology into English can be summarized in six stages.

1. Stage 1:

Term Identification: The translator determines whether the item is a general lexical word or a specialized term and identifies its boundaries within a multiword combination.

2. Stage 2:

Domain Identification: The relevant field is established, such as aerospace, military technology, electrical engineering, mechanics, telecommunications, or another specialized domain.

3. Stage 3:

Contextual Analysis: The surrounding sentences, the type of document, the intended audience, and the broader terminological environment are examined.

4. Stage 4:

Concept Identification: The translator determines what object, process, capability, function, property, or relationship the term actually denotes.

5. Stage 5:

Comparison of Equivalents: Possible English equivalents are compared using specialized dictionaries, authentic technical texts, standards, manuals, and other reliable domain resources.

6. Stage 6:

Evaluation and Consolidation: The selected equivalent is evaluated for conceptual accuracy, natural English usage, terminological acceptability, and consistency with the rest of the document, and then used consistently.

The six-stage model treats equivalence selection as an iterative process rather than a single dictionary lookup. If the selected English term produces conceptual or contextual problems, the translator can return to the earlier stages, reconsider the concept, and compare additional evidence. This makes the model applicable to both individual terms and larger terminological databases.

17. Analysis of Selected Russian-English Examples

1. Russian term: Управление

Possible English equivalents: Control; management; administration; guidance

Equivalent in selected context: Depends on context

Translation note: Polysemy; domain and combination determine the sense.

2. Russian term: Установка

Possible English equivalents: Installation; unit; apparatus; system; facility

Equivalent in selected context: Depends on context

Translation note: Independent translation is risky; the full combination must be analyzed.

3. Russian term: Система управления полётом

Possible English equivalents: Flight management system; flight control system

Equivalent in selected context: Flight control system

Translation note: Conceptual transfer and established aerospace usage.

4. Russian term: Фюзеляж

Possible English equivalents: Fuselage

Equivalent in selected context: Fuselage

Translation note: Relatively stable aerospace equivalent.

5. Russian term: Лонжерон

Possible English equivalents: Spar; main spar

Equivalent in selected context: Spar; main spar

Translation note: Requires aircraft-structure context.

6. Russian term: Шпангоут

Possible English equivalents: Frame; former; fuselage frame

Equivalent in selected context: Frame / fuselage frame

Translation note: The appropriate form depends on technical context.

7. Russian term: Обшивка

Possible English equivalents: Covering; skin; outer shell

Equivalent in selected context: Skin

Translation note: Aerospace context determines the specialized sense.

8. Russian term: Боевая нагрузка

Possible English equivalents: combat load; combat payload

Equivalent in selected context: Depends on platform/context

Translation note: The exact concept must be identified before choosing the equivalent.

9. Russian term: Боевой радиус

Possible English equivalents: Combat radius

Equivalent in selected context: Combat radius

Translation note: Established military terminology.

10. Russian term: Система управления огнём

Possible English equivalents: Fire management system; fire-control system

Equivalent in selected context: Fire-control system

Translation note: Established military terminology; literal management is misleading.

The table demonstrates that no single translation principle can be applied to all terms. Some items have relatively stable equivalents, whereas others require contextual analysis. The difference between control and management, for instance, cannot be resolved solely by the dictionary meaning of “управление”. Similarly, “установка” must be interpreted through the complete technical combination in which it occurs. The translator therefore needs a flexible strategy guided by the conceptual status of each term.

18. Common Errors in Translating Technical and Military Terminology

A common error is excessive reliance on a general dictionary. General dictionaries are useful for identifying broad semantic possibilities, but they rarely provide sufficient evidence for selecting a specialized equivalent. The translator should therefore treat dictionary entries as candidates rather than final answers.

A second error is the independent translation of components in a multiword term. In this approach, every Russian word is translated separately and the resulting English words are assembled. The result may be grammatically acceptable but terminologically unnatural or conceptually inaccurate.

A third error is ignoring the specialized domain. The same Russian word may have different meanings in medicine, military technology, engineering, administration, and ordinary language. Domain identification should therefore precede final equivalence selection.

A fourth error is inconsistent use of equivalents within one document. If the same concept is translated by several English terms without a conceptual reason, readers may interpret them as different concepts. Terminological consistency is consequently part of translation quality, not merely a matter of editorial style.

A fifth error is neglecting the target audience. An equivalent appropriate for a scholarly technical article may differ from the expression suitable for a general educational text. The translator should therefore consider the document genre, audience, and expected level of technical precision.

19. Discussion and Analysis

The analysis of the selected examples indicates that the central issue in technical and military translation is not the transfer of isolated words but the transfer of the relationship among term, concept, and context. Where Russian and English provide closely corresponding terminology, a translation that remains near the source structure can be effective. As the conceptual and terminological distance between the languages increases, however, the need for conceptual strategies becomes greater.

Equivalence selection can therefore be understood as a multi-criteria decision. The translator must consider the lexical meaning of the Russian item, the structure of the combination, the specialized field, the immediate context, the function of the term, target-language conventions, and consistency with other terms in the document. A candidate equivalent that satisfies only one of these criteria may still be inappropriate.

Subject-matter knowledge plays a major role in concept identification. A translator may know the dictionary meanings of “управление”, yet without domain knowledge may not be able to decide whether control, management, administration, or guidance is appropriate in a particular combination. In aerospace and military texts, the problem is amplified because many terms refer to specific structures, systems, capabilities, and performance characteristics.

A useful way to describe the required competence is as the interaction of three forms of knowledge: knowledge of Russian, knowledge of English and its terminology, and knowledge of the specialized subject field. Weakness in any one of these areas can reduce the quality of equivalence selection. Linguistic competence makes the source text understandable; terminological competence helps identify acceptable target expressions; and subject knowledge helps establish what the source term actually denotes.

The analysis also suggests that textual evidence should be treated as part of the reasoning process. When two candidate English terms are possible, the translator can compare their frequency and distribution in relevant technical sources, examine the concepts they normally denote, and check whether they occur with the same neighboring terms. This makes terminology work more transparent and reproducible.

The proposed six-stage model is therefore not intended as a rigid sequence that must be followed mechanically in every case. Rather, it provides a controlled framework for reducing avoidable errors. A translator may move back from equivalent comparison to concept identification if the available English terms reveal a conceptual mismatch. Such iteration is particularly useful in specialized domains where terminology is dense and the cost of a misleading equivalent is high.

20. Conclusion

Translating technical and military terminology from Russian into English cannot be reduced to replacing words from one language with words from another. A specialized term is part of a conceptual and terminological

system, and successful translation requires the intended concept to be represented accurately and intelligibly within the target language and its professional conventions.

The analysis shows that the main challenges include the absence of one-to-one equivalence, lexical polysemy, differences in the structure of multiword terms, strong dependence on context, differences between conceptual systems, and the need for subject-matter knowledge. Terms such as “управление” and “установка” demonstrate that a polysemous Russian word cannot be assigned one fixed English equivalent independently of context. The example “система управления полётом” further shows that a literal translation may be lexically plausible while failing to express the intended aerospace concept as precisely as an established target-language term.

The findings also indicate that literal translation should not be rejected as a method. It remains useful when the semantic and terminological structures of Russian and English correspond sufficiently. The problem arises when formal similarity creates a false impression of equivalence. In such cases, conceptual transfer provides a more reliable basis for selecting the target expression because it starts from the specialized concept rather than from the surface form of the source term.

The proposed process begins with term identification, continues through domain and contextual analysis, proceeds to concept identification and comparison of candidate equivalents, and ends with evaluation and consolidation. At the final stage, the selected term should be checked for conceptual accuracy, naturalness in English technical usage, consistency with the terminology of the document, and suitability for the intended audience.

The six-stage model can serve as a practical procedure for translators, editors, and terminology specialists working with Russian technical and military texts. It encourages systematic use of specialized dictionaries and authentic textual sources while recognizing that dictionaries alone cannot determine the correct equivalent in every context. It also highlights the importance of subject knowledge as part of translation competence.

Finally, conceptual transfer should not be understood as a complete rejection of literal translation. Rather, it calls for conscious use of literal translation where it is appropriate and a deliberate move beyond source-language form when that form does not adequately represent the target concept. Applying this distinction consistently can reduce word-for-word errors and contribute to more precise, coherent, and professionally acceptable English translations of Russian technical and military terminology.

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